MEMORANDUM

TO: **Bret Pehrson**
IT Software Developer IV
UIT Univ Support Services

FROM**:** **Reza Sarijlou**
Mgr, Software Dev. Engrg
UIT Univ Support Services

DATE: **June 9, 2026**

SUBJECT: **Notification of Decision to Terminate Employment**

The purpose of this memorandum is to notify you that after careful consideration of the information presented during the Pre-Disciplinary Conference held on June 2, 2026, and with the concurrence of Karen Iannucci, UHRM Associate Director, I have decided to terminate your employment for the reasons outlined in the Notification of Pre-Disciplinary Conference, except to the extent specifically described below.

You had an opportunity to address the allegations at the Pre-Disciplinary Conference. As stated in the Pre-Disciplinary Conference Notification; during our conversation on April 27, 2026, you acknowledged that you asked a coworker to come to your cubicle and when they arrived at your cubicle, you lowered your pants to your ankles. During our conversation in April, you shared that it was intended as a joke, though you also acknowledged that it was inappropriate and a lapse in judgment. During the Pre-Disciplinary Conference, you again admitted that you did lower your pants when your coworker arrived at your cubicle. You stated that while it was intended as a joke; you are aware it was inappropriate that you would not do this again moving forward.

The Pre-Disciplinary Conference Notification also stated during our conversation on April 27, 2026, you acknowledged that roughly a year ago during an interaction in a workplace restroom, you exposed yourself to the same coworker while discussing and demonstrating an adult device. You acknowledged that this interaction occurred, though you stated it was not intended to be sexual in nature. You further stated that you “effed up” and that you “trusted the wrong person.” During the Pre-Disciplinary Conference, you again admitted to bringing an adult device into the workplace. You stated that after your coworker asked if they could see it on, you proceeded to meet your coworker in the workplace restroom and exposed yourself while demonstrating how the adult device was intended to be worn. You acknowledged that while it was your understanding that this was a consensual interaction; it was inappropriate and that you would not do this again moving forward. You stated in the conference that you, “don’t want to try and excuse yourself” and, “it was wrong.”

During the Pre-Disciplinary Conference you also had the opportunity to respond to the allegation that you had masturbated at work. You denied the allegation. I have excluded this allegation from the decision to terminate your employment.

The decision to terminate is based solely on the admitted conduct described above as it is unacceptable and will not be tolerated; your behavior was inconsistent with expectations of professional conduct within the University of Utah workplace environment.

The effective date of your termination and your last paid day will be **June 9, 2026**. Additionally, if you are enrolled in the University Benefits program, your last day of benefits will be **June 15, 2026**.

You are required to turn into me all assigned University/Department property within three (3) working days of receipt of this letter. This includes, but is not limited to, your staff identification card and keys.

Your conduct was such that the University has terminated you from your position as IT Software Developer IV. In addition, the conduct which resulted in your termination is considered so serious that the University has decided to designate you as ineligible for employment or volunteer opportunities for a minimum of five (5) years. If you have objections regarding our decision to make you ineligible for application, please provide a written response to the Chief Human Resources Officer for University Human Resources Management, University of Utah, 250 E. 200 S. Suite 125, Salt Lake City, Utah 84111 within 30 calendar days of the date of this letter. That date is **July 9, 2026**. Your response will be considered and a final decision rendered as quickly as possible. Please note that this decision and the final decision following your response are not subject to the employee grievance provisions described in University *Policy* 5-203.

If we do not receive a response from you by July 9, 2026, you will remain ineligible for application until at least **June 9, 2031**. At any time after June 9, 2031, you may submit a written request to the Chief Human Resources Officer for University Human Resources Management seeking to have your designation rescinded. In the event that your request is approved, you will be considered eligible again for employment and volunteer service with the University of Utah. If you have questions regarding this correspondence, please contact Karen Iannucci, HR Associate Director at 801-587-9771.

You have the right to appeal this action in accordance with the provisions of University *Policy* 5-203. Grievances must be initiated within five (5) working days of the event prompting the grievance. Time parameters for filing an appeal are stringent. You may review the policy at www.regulations.utah.edu/humanResources/5-203.html and/or contact Joanna Kreifeldt, Appeals Coordinator, at Joanna.kreifeldt@utah.edu or 801-581-5469 for procedural guidelines and questions. If you desire, you may prepare a written response to the memorandum to include in your personnel file. Please be aware that a written response does not initiate the appeal process.

You may also seek redress, in accordance with University *Policy* 1-012, in instances of alleged illegal discrimination. Complaints of discrimination are to be filed within 120 calendar days of the date of the last alleged occurrence through the Office of Equal Opportunity and Title IX at 383 South University Street Level 1 OEO Suite, Salt Lake City, UT 84112 or call 801-581-8365. Copies of this Policy, and all other University policies, are available on the University's web site at www.regulations.utah.edu/info/policyList.html.

If you are enrolled in health care coverage through the University, you may receive information regarding your possible continuation of health care coverage under COBRA. The University offers an Employee Assistance Program. For more information on what is available to you, please visit https://benefits.utah.edu/employee-assistance-program-and-mental-health/ or contact the program for a confidential consultation at (888) 881-5462. If you have questions regarding continuation of any other University benefits or the EAP, information is available on the internet at www.hr.utah.edu/ben or by contacting the Benefits Department at 801-581-7447. State and federal labor law notifications can be found at https://www.hr.utah.edu/serviceTeams/employee-notices.php and/or in University Human Resources offices. If you have any other questions, you may contact Karen Iannucci, HR Associate Director, at 801-587-9771.

cc: HR Associate Director – Karen Iannucci
Employee Relations Office
Benefits Office
Employee File